VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE TESLA DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on Tesla's cars, autonomy, robots, energy and stock

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF MON OCT 19 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

Results tomorrow, and a new FSD build today

Tesla reports its third quarter after Wednesday's close. The 23 analysts in the company's own compiled consensus, posted Monday, expect $28.34 billion in revenue, 45 cents a share in adjusted earnings and negative free cash flow of $4.51 billion as capital spending runs near $7.8 billion. On Tuesday the company began rolling out software update 2026.38.5.10 with FSD (Supervised) v14.3.13 for AI4 cars and v14.3 Lite for HW3, Not a Tesla App lists.

In a letter filed Monday evening, the board asked shareholders to re-elect Elon Musk, Robyn Denholm and JB Straubel and said FSD now has nearly 1.5 million paid customers. TSLA rose 3.76% to $368.06 on Monday as AI stocks rebounded and Tesla gave the consumer sector its second-biggest lift, Reuters reported.

TOMORROW · Q3 EARNINGS

Third-quarter results on Wednesday

Wed Oct 21 · results after the close · live Q&A webcast 5:30 p.m. EDT

The date comes from Tesla's October 2 8-K; the shareholder update and webcast will be on ir.tesla.com. The company-compiled consensus (23 firms, Oct 19) has automotive revenue at $20.27 billion, energy at $3.72 billion and services at $4.35 billion; gross margin at 17.9%; operating income at $721 million; and GAAP earnings of 23 cents a share. Yahoo Finance shows 45 cents on $28.11 billion (25 and 28 estimates), while Reuters cites 43 cents on $27.88 billion. A year ago Tesla earned 50 cents a share on $28.10 billion. Investors are focused on robotaxis, Optimus and spending: Tesla has said capital spending will top $25 billion this year, Reuters noted.

COMPANY-COMPILED CONSENSUS, Q3 2026 (23 FIRMS)

MEASURE	REVENUE	GROSS MARGIN	OPERATING INCOME	ADJ. EPS	OPERATING CASH FLOW	CAPEX	FREE CASH FLOW	CASH
Q3 estimate	$28.34B	17.9%	$721M	$0.45	$3.27B	$7.77B	−$4.51B	$39.01B

For the full year the same group expects 1,783,692 vehicle deliveries and 52.4 gigawatt-hours of energy storage deployments, according to Tesla.

I · FULL SELF-DRIVING (FSD)

v14.3.13 starts rolling out

A rebuilt compiler, a new collision-evasion feature and one model for FSD, Summon and Robotaxi.

What is in the build

FSD (Supervised) v14.3.13 upgrades the reinforcement-learning stage of training and the vision encoder, and "rewrote the AI compiler and runtime from the ground up with MLIR, resulting in 20% faster reaction time," according to the release notes published by Teslascope. It "unified the model between Actually Smart Summon, FSD, and Robotaxi," raises Actually Smart Summon's top speed to 8 mph, improves handling of emergency vehicles, school buses, small animals and compound traffic lights, and shows the distance driven without an intervention. Tesla lists pothole avoidance as an upcoming improvement.

The same update adds Automatic Collision Evasion for HW4 cars, which "activates Full Self-Driving (Supervised) to try to keep your vehicle safe and then continue driving" when it detects an inattentive driver, according to Not a Tesla App. HW3 cars get v14.3 Lite, which "distilled the intelligence from

HW4 V14 into HW3" and adds parking, unparking, reversing and arrival options. The rollout began Tuesday and was in its earliest stage, with TeslaFi counting a single car, the site showed.



A Tesla Cybercab on Harrison Street in San Francisco on June 12, 2026.

PHOTO: 9YZ, "TESLA CYBERCAB - SAN FRANCISCO - JUNE 2026," WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0 · CROPPED

QUICK HIT

Also in the update. 2026.38.5.10 lets owners set a trip's arrival charge from the phone app, adds a Halloween mode with a ghost costume for the car on screen, drops the beta label from Grok, and gives HW3 cars a "Sloth" speed profile that drives slower than Chill, Not a Tesla App lists.

The board's tally

Tesla's shareholder letter says it grew FSD (Supervised) "usage exponentially, reaching nearly 1.5 million paid customers and more than 15 billion cumulative miles driven to date," expanded Robotaxi to seven U.S. cities and deployed Cybercabs "without steering wheels or pedals in our Robotaxi fleet," according to the filing. Tesla's Robotaxi account said on October 10 that it had "scaled to 300+ Cybercabs serving Austin," and Ashok Elluswamy, Tesla's head of AI software, added "Dallas soon," Teslarati reported; sworn answers to a National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) audit query on the Cybercab's safety certification are due October 30.

II · SALES & DEMAND

Some Model Y L buyers wait until 2027

Early U.S. orders for the six-seater are slipping by months while others are delivered.

New U.S. orders for the $61,990 Model Y L Launch Series now show delivery from January to March 2027, up from January to February, and some earlier buyers see February to April, Not a Tesla App reported on Monday. One reader told the site a mid-October delivery had been "pushed out 3 to 4 months," while an owner in South Florida took delivery last week. Tesla has not commented. The six-seat crossover went on sale in the U.S. in early July with first deliveries planned for September.

QUICK HIT

Quarter so far. Tesla delivered 486,532 vehicles in the third quarter, beating estimates, and is on track to grow deliveries this year for the first time since 2023, Reuters noted; the board's letter says Tesla has delivered more than 10 million vehicles to date.

III · ENERGY & CHARGING

Storm Watch, site maps and four new Superchargers

The energy business is expected to bring in $3.72 billion in the quarter.

"Electricity goes out, I know my family's safe, and that means a lot to me," a Powerwall owner in Hawaii says in a video Tesla Energy posted on Monday, explaining how Storm Watch charges the battery ahead of a storm. The board's letter says Tesla has deployed more than 130 gigawatt-hours of storage to date, with record deployments from Megafactory Shanghai, and has begun producing Megapack 3 in Texas.

Update 2026.38.5.10 brings Supercharger site maps with live stall occupancy at pilot locations and "Emergency Drive Away," which lets a driver shift into Drive with the cable still connected, at the risk of damage, according to Not a Tesla App. Tesla Charging announced new eight-stall sites in Cherokee, North Carolina, a voting winner; Bolu, Türkiye (post); and two in Goyang, South Korea (post, post).

IV · THE ANNUAL MEETING

"Your vote is critical"

Tesla opened its campaign for the December 3 meeting and a drawing for in-person seats.



Building 1 at Tesla's Gigafactory Texas near Austin, shown on June 17, 2022. The 2026 annual meeting will be held there and online.
PHOTO: LARRY D. MOORE / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0 (CROPPED)

"This year, we're asking you to vote 'FOR' all three proposals on the ballot, including the re-election of Elon Musk, Robyn Denholm and JB Straubel to Tesla's Board," Tesla posted at 10:31 a.m. EDT Monday. "Your vote is critical to helping us maintain that momentum." The board's letter calls Musk "the architect of our transformation" and says "continuity of leadership matters," according to the filing, which also lists Innisfree M&A as proxy solicitor.

What the letter points to

The board frames 2026 as the year it began "executing" Part IV of the Master Plan, "designed to create a world of amazing abundance for all." Beyond FSD and Robotaxi, it cites a Semi factory opening in Nevada, a high-volume Optimus production line in Fremont, and the Terafab initiative "to secure supply of critical components at scale," and says Tesla scaled core vehicle production "10x in just six years," according to the filing.

Seats at Gigafactory Texas will go by random drawing among holders as of October 13; entries close at 12:59 a.m. EST on Saturday, November 7, and Tesla expects to notify those selected the week of November 16, VoteTesla.com says. Selections are non-transferable, and any holder as of October 13 can join online with a 16-digit control number.

V · SEC FILINGS

A letter to shareholders

One filing for Tesla, Inc. (CIK 0001318605) was accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Monday and 8:45 a.m. EDT Tuesday.

Takeaways

1. Tesla reports Q3 after Wednesday's close; the webcast is at 5:30 p.m. EDT.
2. Its compiled consensus sees $28.34 billion in revenue and 45 cents a share.
3. FSD v14.3.13 and v14.3 Lite began rolling out Tuesday.
4. The board says FSD has nearly 1.5 million paid customers.
5. TSLA rose 3.76% to $368.06 Monday.

DEFA14A · Oct 19, 5:12 p.m. EDT — Additional proxy materials: a board letter urging votes for all proposals, copies of VoteTesla.com, tesla.com and investor-relations pages, digital ads and an X post. Filing

Insider trades, last 120 days (Form 4) — Sep 8: Chief Financial Officer Vaibhav Taneja sold 2,605.75 shares at $360.13 after 6,539 restricted stock units vested on Sep 5 (filed Sep 9).

SOURCES

Posts by @Tesla, @teslaenergy and @TeslaCharging on X; SEC EDGAR; Tesla Investor Relations; VoteTesla.com; Reuters, Not a Tesla App, Teslascope, Teslarati; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: Wikimedia Commons (9yz, CC BY 4.0; Larry D. Moore, CC BY 4.0).

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Up 3.8% as AI stocks bounced

TSLA opened at its low and closed near the high, giving the consumer sector its second-biggest lift as the Nasdaq rose 1.11%, Reuters reported.

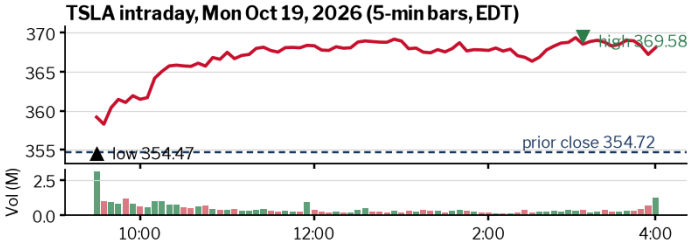
CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$368.06	+$13.34	$357.50	$369.58	$354.47
Mon Oct 19, 4:00 p.m. EDT	+3.76% vs $354.72	regular session	3:05 p.m. EDT bar	9:30 a.m. EDT bar

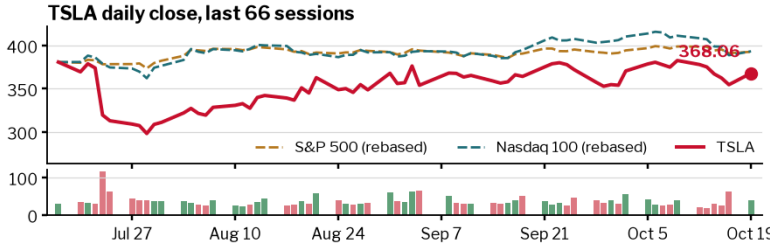
VOLUME	52-WEEK RANGE	MARKET CAP	5-DAY / 1-MONTH	YEAR TO DATE
38.74M	$297–$499	$1.45T	−2.64% / +1.04%	−18.16%
+7.2% vs 30-session avg 36.13M	$297.38 (Jul 29, 2026) to $498.83 (Dec 22, 2025)	3.95B shares (10-Q cover, Jul 16) × close	5 and 21 sessions	vs Dec 31, 2025 close

52-WEEK RANGE, OCT 19

low $297.38 · Jul 29 — close $368.06 — high $498.83 · Dec 22, 2025

50-day avg $360.25 200-day avg $387.58





As of close Oct 19, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 19 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	YTD
TSLA	**+3.76%**	**−2.64%**	**+1.04%**	**−18.16%**
S&P 500	+0.41%	−1.49%	+0.53%	+12.35%
Nasdaq 100	+1.17%	−3.70%	−0.39%	+16.95%
RIVN	−0.64%	−8.86%	−17.68%	−37.39%
GM	−1.44%	+0.46%	+0.67%	+1.76%
F	−2.01%	+1.50%	−7.80%	−7.16%

OPTIONS (CBOE, TUE OCT 20, 8:38 A.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 23	210,079	189,520	0.90	90.1%	$400 / $130
Oct 26	21,767	12,458	0.57	64.5%	$455 / $360
Oct 28	6,220	6,326	1.02	60.8%	$420 / $350
All expiries	**3,082,587**	**2,325,668**	**0.75**		**30-day IV index 45.3**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 20

Strong buy	4
Buy	15
Hold	21
Sell	2
Strong sell	2
Mean rating (1 = strong buy)	2.36
Mean target (38 analysts)	$397.83 (+8.1%)
Median target	$412.50
High / low target	$600.00 / $128.11

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	70.93M
Change vs. mid-September	−4.4%
Short % of float	2.01%
Days to cover	1.79
Held by insiders	17.82%
Held by institutions	43.72%
BlackRock, Jun 30	5.42%
Vanguard, Jun 30	4.66%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 19 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS $1.08)	340.8
Forward P/E (EPS est. $2.17)	169.7
Price/sales (rev. $103.6B)	14.0
Beta (5-year monthly)	1.92
50-day average	$360.25 (+2.2%)
200-day average	$387.58 (−5.0%)
Q3 EPS est. (25 analysts)	$0.45
Q3 revenue est. (28)	$28.11B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 20	Cantor Fitzgerald	Overweight	$485
Oct 15	GLJ Research	Sell	$24.86
Oct 12	Jefferies	Hold	$350 to $400
Oct 8	Tigress Financial	Buy	$550
Oct 7	UBS	Neutral	$385 to $391
Sep 28	JPMorgan	Neutral	$445 to $415
Sep 25	StoneX	Buy	$475

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Tue Oct 20	SpaceX Q3 results; webcast 4:30 p.m. EDT
Wed Oct 21	**Q3 results after close; webcast 5:30 p.m. EDT**
Fri Oct 23	Weekly options expiry (largest near-term OI)
Fri Oct 30	Cybercab answers due to NHTSA
Sat Nov 7	In-person meeting drawing closes, 12:59 a.m. EST
Wed Dec 2	Proxy voting deadline, 11:59 p.m. EST
Thu Dec 3	**Annual meeting, 4:00 p.m. EST**

Largest single option positions: Jan 15, 2027 $960 calls (112,152 OI) and $940 calls (93,686). Prices and averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 19). Consensus, targets, rating actions, short interest (as of Sep 30), ownership (holders as of Jun 30) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Tue Oct 20, 8:43 a.m. EDT; P/E (price to earnings per share, EPS) and price/sales recomputed at the Oct 19 close. Shares: Tesla 10-Q cover page, Jul 16, 2026. Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) is contracts outstanding after Monday's close, P/C is the put/call ratio by OI, ATM IV is implied volatility at the $367.50 strike at Monday's close. Earnings date: Tesla 8-K, Oct 2. Meeting and drawing: DEF 14A, VoteTesla.com; SpaceX: IR. NHTSA deadline: Teslarati.